```
        // return (optional)
    }

    function decrement (uint n) public {          ❷
        value = value - n;

    }
}
```

❶ Shared data for the Counter value

❷ Functions of the Counter

A function is defined by the `function` keyword and the name of the function, followed by the parameter type and name and the body of the function within curly braces. You can see the definitions of four functions in listing 2.1: `initialize()`, `get()`, `increment()`, and `decrement()`. You'll also observe that there is no definition for an explicit constructor. In this case, a default constructor is used for deploying the contract.

All the functions are declared `public` and therefore have public visibility (as opposed to private), which means that any valid participant (or account) on the blockchain can invoke these functions. The function definitions can end with a `return` statement, which is optional unless there is an explicit value to be returned, as is the case with the `get()` function. The `initialize()`, `increment()`, and `decrement()` functions receive a value as a parameter, and the function body uses the parameter value to update the variable `value`. Behind the scenes, each function invocation is recorded as a transaction on the distributed ledger. Any state change of `value` is also recorded.